This *API is* obviously a simple one, but it contains all the database interactions you need with its two *entities*: `Recipe` and `Ingredient`.

DEFINITION An *entity* is a .NET class that's mapped by EF Core to the database. These are classes you define, typically as POCO classes, that can be saved and loaded by mapping to database tables using EF Core.

When you interact with EF Core, you'll be using primarily POCO entities and a database context that inherits from the `DbContext` EF Core class. The entity classes are the object-oriented representations of the tables in your database; they represent the data you want to store in the database. You use the `DbContext` in your application both to configure EF Core and access the database at runtime.

NOTE You can potentially have multiple `DbContext`s in your application and even configure them to integrate with different databases.

When your application first uses EF Core, EF Core creates an internal representation of the database based on the `DbSet<T>` properties on your application's `DbContext` and the entity classes themselves, as shown in figure 12.3.